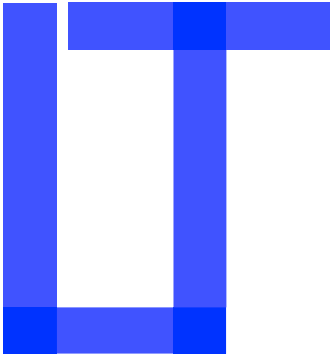




Luisa Torres Varas

**Geospatial Analyst
Architect
Photographer**

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date of birth: 04 march 2000
marital status: single
residence permit in Switzerland: no

I am a geospatial analyst, architect, and photographer — three practices that have attuned me to reading territory at different scales. My work moves between big data and small data, the intimate scale of lived and situated data, seeking to make complex territorial dynamics legible and understandable. In that legibility I find bridges between design, research, and data-driven decision-making; a tool that informs and moves toward action, in service of communities and territories that resist unequal power dynamics.

education

Master's in Advanced Urbanism and Data Analysis

Institute for Advanced Architecture of Catalonia (2024–2026)

Mobility for Everyone: Gender, Age, and Mobility

Escuela de Movilidad Sostenible (2024) 60hrs

Walkable Cities: Pedestrians, Public Space, and Universal Accessibility

Escuela de Movilidad Sostenible (2023) 60hrs

Architecture – Creative Studies

Tecnológico de Monterrey, Querétaro Campus (2019–2023)

University Exchange

Jönköping University, Sweden (01-07/ 2022)
Concentration in Urban Space

Linguistics and Cultural Exchange

Vienna, Austria (2017-2018)

Linguistics and Cultural Exchange

Rhode Island, USA (2014-2015)

Languages

-Spanish Native
-English C1 Toefl IBT
-German A2

Hard skills

-Geospatial & Remote Sensing
-Programming & Data Analysis
-Machine Learning & AI
-Data Visualization
-Parametric & 3D
-Workflow & Automation

Work Experience

Dérive Lab | between research, art, architecture, urban design, and other disciplines
- Junior Designer: 3D modeling, visual documentation, exhibition assembly, and development of conceptual and communication materials for interdisciplinary projects.

External Reference | between research, architecture, art, and digital tools
- Research and Publications Assistant.

Institute for Advanced Architecture of Catalonia

| educational and architectural research center in Barcelona
- Research and Teaching Assistant in the Data-driven Urban Design Studio: Data, Design & Spatial Justice in Action.

Projects

Beyond the Data Point: A Counter-Cartography of People on the Move through Mexico's Vertical Border

Master's Thesis at IAAC (2026)
Research focused on developing counter-mapping methodologies to spatialize testimonies of migrants using LLMs, critically addressing their structural biases. The work transforms migratory narratives into forms of spatial and relational knowledge capable of revealing invisibilized patterns of violence and amplifying the collective voice of migratory experiences.

External Reference's DNA | External Reference & Actar Publishers (2026)

Research on the relationship between affective states evoked by architectural spaces and their quantifiable spatial qualities through artificial intelligence and computer vision, based on the analysis of the photographic archive of the studio's projects.

Hobbies

Photography
Futball
Tennis

Soft skills

-Critical Thinking
-Cross-scale translation
-Interdisciplinary fluency
-Visual communication
-Social and human sensibility



Quito in Transition | Institute for Advanced Architecture of Catalonia (2025)
Spatial analysis of urban mobility with a feminist perspective, featuring a collaborative web map and catalogue of interventions to empower women users of public transport in Quito.

Stolen River: Unmasking Nile's Land Grabbed Territories

| Institute for Advanced Architecture of Catalonia (2025)
Satellite detection of land grabbing in the Nile basin using Python, computer vision, and Sentinel imagery, visualized on an open-access interactive web platform.

Layers of Besòs | Institute for Advanced Architecture of Catalonia (2024)

Urban research on insecurity, identity, and economy in Besòs, with a public space intervention proposal using generative AI and participatory design.

Metabolic Rift: The Ever Changing Landscape of Flooding

| Institute for Advanced Architecture of Catalonia (2024)
Research on flood risk associated with DANA episodes and the absorption capacity of different vegetation types in Mediterranean cities, integrating historical cartography, parametric mapping, and geospatial modeling with Grasshopper.

Interface to the Future | Dérive Lab (2024)
Art, science, and technology project that explores and makes Anthropocene dynamics visible through workshops, walks, and exhibition devices.

Devenires del Consumo | Tecnológico de Monterrey & INAH (2023)

Critical cartography of the Querétaro River through the analysis of 759 plastic residues, linking global production, local consumption, and territorial impact.

Awards / Recognition

Community Award: People, Places and Cultures Award IAAC (2025). Outstanding Performance

Presentation at the University of Miami and 10Design/SB Architects
Selected Thesis Project

Exhibition at the Museo de la Ciudad Querétaro
Devenires del Consumo Research

Portfolio link!

<https://luisatvaras.github.io/portfolio2026/>